



The Selectboard
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON
TOWN HALL
1 SOUTH ROAD
WESTHAMPTON, MASSACHUSETTS 01027

MINUTES of the MEETING

Monday, April 8, 2024, at 7:00 PM

The Westhampton Selectboard scheduled a regular meeting to be held on Monday, April 8, 2024, at 7:00 PM at the Town Offices, 1 South Road.

Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 7:00 PM

Present: Maureen Dempsey, Chair; Scott Johndrow, Susan Bronstein.

Others Present: Douglas Finn; others as noted.

General Business

CY2024 Business License Renewal – Stillman Brooks

A request for a renewal of a sales license was received from Mr. Stillman Brooks.

After review, it was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Bronstein

To approve the license for the 2024 Calendar Year as requested.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:01 PM)

Perry Hill Road Ext. Bridge Replacement

Mr. Finn presented a draft letter for review, acknowledging that the proposed replacement of the Perry Hill Road Extension bridge would result in a closure of that portion of the road to foot and pedestrian traffic during the project.

After review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve the draft letter, and to sign.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:02 PM)

Department Reports

Highway

Mr. Jablonski reported updates on recent work, including catch-basin cleaning, storm-drain unclogging, significant amount of brush chipping, dirt-road grading; he reported that staff had attended PPE and Hazardous Materials Handling training; Chris Alexander has started as a part-time temporary staff. A tree company has started taking down road-side trees (as marked by the Tree Warden). New lights were placed on the vehicle for the Fire Department; broken windows repaired at Town Hall; Ballot box fixed for Town Clerk; additional road repairs and maintenance.

Second reading: WES Generator Repairs

Mr. Jablonski reviewed the itemized estimate for generator repairs at the Elementary School. He noted that while the estimate for repair was less than \$6,000, but requested an appropriation of \$6,500.

After some discussion, it was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Bronstein

To appropriate \$6,500 from ARPA for the purpose of funding repairs to the Westhampton Elementary School Generator, as presented.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:09 PM)

Other Departments

Administrative Business

Town Meeting Warrant

Mr. Finn presented an updated draft of the proposed Town Meeting warrant for review, noting minor changes since last review. No action.

Proposed warrant article from HRS - Capital Projects Stabilization Fund

Mr. Finn noted a request as received from the Hampshire Regional School, and that the request came after the 45-day deadline as imposed by the General Bylaw for warrant article submission.

Ms. Bronstein – seems to make sense to add the stabilization fund.

Mr. Johndrow agreed with establishing the fund, but recognized that they do not have the capacity to add the

After review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow

To add the proposed warrant article to the Warrant for Annual Town Meeting.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:20 PM)

ARPA

Review / Amend appropriation schedule for all closed projects

Mr. Finn requested a vote to approve revised appropriations for projects that were funded by appropriation from the Covid/CLFRF funding (“ARPA”) and presented a revised appropriation schedule.

After review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow

To Approve the revised appropriations as presented on the schedule named “ARPA FUNDING” and dated April 3, 2024, and as further reviewed.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:26 PM)

Invoice Review: Northeast Solar (Site Assessment services)

A request was received for funding to pay for an invoice from Northeast Solar for a recent site assessment and technical specifications packet.

After review, it was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Bronstein

To appropriate \$625.00 from ARPA for the purpose of funding a roof-mounted solar PV site assessment, as presented.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:31 PM)

Mr. Finn noted that the required annual “ARPA” report had been completed and submitted.

New Municipal Website

Mr. Finn led a discussion about the proposed upgrade to the municipal website.

Mr. Finn noted that the website upgrades were intended to expand the accessibility of the site, including ADA / WCAG compliant, as well as ‘device agnostic’ information delivery.

Mr. Finn noted that quotes were requested from several vendors through an informal procurement process. Both the price for work as proposed, and operational costs to the town moving forward were considered.

A proposed scope of work and implementation plan from Tuman Designs was presented and reviewed. Mr. Finn recommended the vendor, not only for the cost of the site development, but also for the cost of site maintenance after completion, which should be significantly less than any other party.

Mr. Finn requested approval of the proposal, and the contract for website development services with Tuman Design.

After review, it was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve the contract and to sign.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (7:47 PM)

Other Administrative Updates

Mr. Finn noted that he would be out of the office between May 22 and June 2.

Mr. Finn also reminded members that on Monday, May 27, at about 11 AM, Memorial Day Observances would be held per tradition, starting on the Town Common.

Review Correspondence if any

A letter from Eversource in regard to their rights-of-way Vegetation Control program was reviewed.

Ms. Dempsey noted a letter than she had received from Mary Cleary, expressing concerns about the funding levels at the high school, and the use of extensive reserves in reducing the assessments from the Town.

Review and Sign: Payroll and A/P Warrants: W24-21, WP24-21

After review, it was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Bronstein

To approve Warrants W24-21 and WP24-21, and to sign.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (8:03 PM)

Review and Sign: Minutes from Previous Meetings

The minutes of March 25, 2024 were reviewed, with minor corrections made.

It was MOVED by Bronstein, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve the minutes as presented and amended.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (8:04 PM)

Set date for next meetings –

The following upcoming meetings or events were noted:

April 22 (7 PM), May 6 (7 PM)

Town Meeting: May 11, 9 AM

Executive Session – if needed or requested

Mr. Finn requested Executive Session Requested to discuss matters related to pending litigation.

It was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Bronstein;

To enter into executive session for the purposes of approving minutes from a previous executive session, and to discuss matters relative to pending litigation.

VOTED: JOHNDROW – YES; BRONSTEIN – YES; DEMPSEY – YES.

The board entered executive session at 8:06 PM.

Executive Session

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, it was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Bronstein

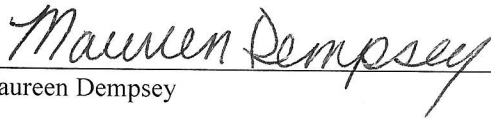
To exit Executive Session and immediately to adjourn.

VOTED: JOHNDROW – YES; BRONSTEIN – YES; DEMPSEY – YES. (8:12 PM)

Respectfully submitted,

Douglas C. Finn

Approved by a vote of the Selectboard at a regular meeting, held on April 22, 2024.


Maureen Dempsey


Scott Johndrow


Susan Bronstein